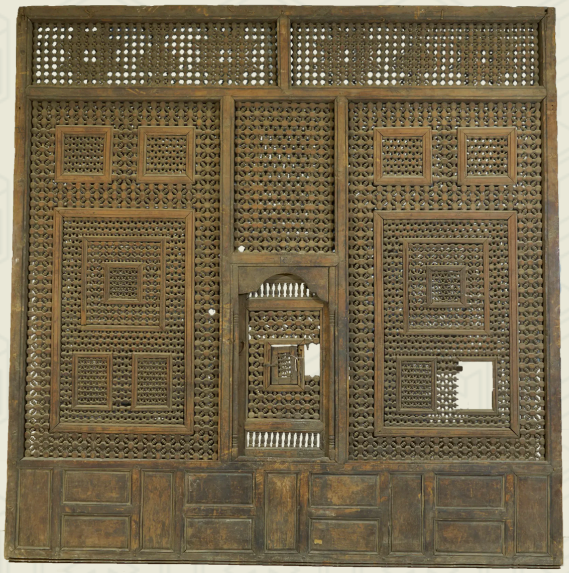
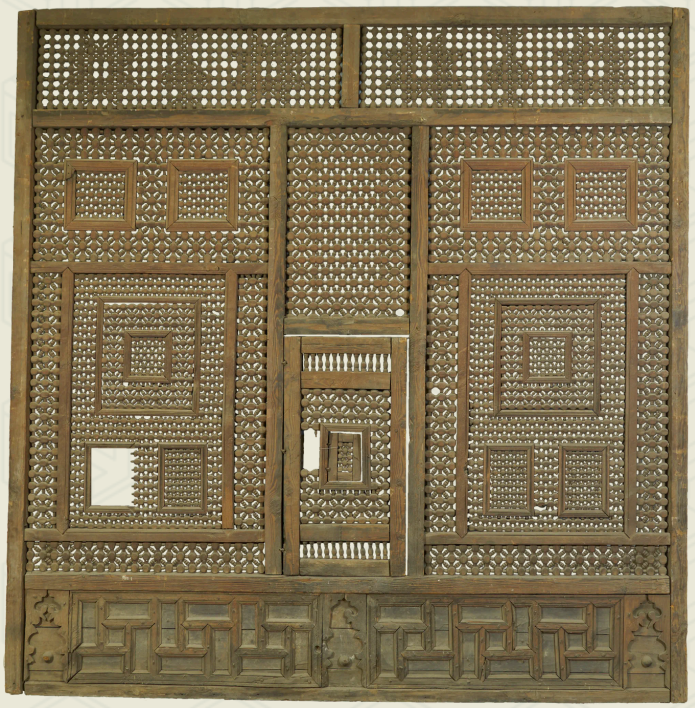
Mashrabeya

W: 232 cm; H: 229 cm

Inv. no. 612





Lathe-turned mashrabeya with an upper panel decorated with four eight-pointed stars, arranged in pairs flanking an olla waterjug. As in No. 596, the small central opening, crowned by a row of baramiq (“balusters”), slides upwards and is secured by a stop-peg mechanism characteristic of Ottoman window work. From a technical standpoint, particular note should be made of the thick upper and lower framing bands of the large rectangular panels flanking the window, each fashioned from a single continuous length of wood forming a straight horizontal member. This solution enhances structural stability while remaining visually unobtrusive. The craftsman’s skill lies in the successful concealment of this unified structural element beneath what appears to be a heterogeneous assemblage of lathe-turned elements. Typical of Ottoman woodwork, the range of turning typologies employed here - including mawg (“wave”) motifs, salib fadi (“empty cross”), and mosaddas (“hexagon”) forms - attests both to the versatility of the technique and the inventiveness of its maker.

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